

Soc Internship Day 15

Assignment

- 1 Explain log correlation
- 2 Identify attack chain from logs
- 3 Write full attack sequence

(1)

Log correlation is the process of collecting and connecting logs from different systems, devices, and applications to identify related events and detect security incidents. Instead of looking at a single log entry, log correlation helps analysts see the full attack chain by linking multiple events together.

(2)

Step 1: Failed Logins Failed login from 185.23.11.5 Failed login from 185.23.11.5

Step 2: Successful Login Login success from 185.23.11.5

Step 3: Suspicious Activity File accessed: /admin/config

The chain log confirm the attack used by here is Brute Force attack

(3)

Full Attack Sequence Analysis

Incident Summary

Suspicious activity was detected from IP address **185.23.11.5**. Log correlation revealed multiple failed login attempts followed by a successful login and access to a sensitive administrative configuration file.

Attack Sequence

Phase 1: Credential Access Attempt

The attacker initiated multiple login attempts against the target system from IP address **185.23.11.5**.

Observed Events:

- Failed login from 185.23.11.5
- Failed login from 185.23.11.5

Analysis:

Repeated authentication failures from the same source indicate an attempt to gain access using guessed credentials. This behavior is consistent with a brute-force or password-spraying attack.

Phase 2: Successful Authentication

After several failed attempts, the same IP address successfully authenticated to the system.

Observed Event:

- Login success from 185.23.11.5

Analysis:

The successful login immediately following failed attempts suggests the attacker may have obtained valid credentials and gained unauthorized access to the account.

Phase 3: Post-Compromise Activity

Following authentication, the account accessed a sensitive administrative configuration file.

Observed Event:

- File accessed: /admin/config

Analysis:

Access to the /admin/config file may indicate reconnaissance, information gathering, or preparation for further malicious actions. Configuration files often contain sensitive system settings, user information, or security-related data.

Attack Timeline

1. Attacker attempts multiple logins from 185.23.11.5.
2. Authentication attempts initially fail.
3. A successful login occurs from the same IP address.
4. The attacker gains access to the account.
5. The attacker accesses the sensitive file /admin/config.
6. Potential compromise of system configuration information.

Attack Type

Brute Force Attack → Unauthorized Access → Sensitive File Access

Severity

High

Recommended Actions

1. Verify whether the login was performed by a legitimate user.
2. Reset the affected account password immediately.
3. Review all activities performed after the successful login.
4. Check for additional file modifications or downloads.
5. Block or monitor IP address 185.23.11.5.
6. Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA).
7. Escalate the incident to the L2 SOC team for further investigation.

Status

Escalated for investigation.